

CRIME INVESTIGATION — SUSPECT PROFILES

Case Reference: CHN-2025-FR-0034

Total Suspects: 8

Each suspect profile begins with 'SUSPECT: Name' as required by the Crime Investigation DSS.

SUSPECT: Subramaniam Pillai

Subramaniam Pillai, age 58. Managing Director and primary promoter of Lakshmi Prosperity Chit Fund Pvt. Ltd. Founded and controlled the fraudulent scheme. Bank records show Rs. 1.4 crore transferred to his wife's accounts in the two weeks before the scheme collapsed. CCTV confirms he was removing documents from the office on 27 October 2025 — the night before the closure. His phone was switched off on 28 October and has not been reachable since. Currently absconding — a non-bailable warrant has been issued. Prior case of cheating filed in 2018 in Coimbatore, settled out of court. The double-ledger Excel sheets were found on a laptop registered to his name. Enforcement Directorate has attached his Adyar flat. Primary accused — maximum motive, direct control of funds, and premeditated fraud confirmed by forensic audit. Absconding itself is strong evidence of guilt.

SUSPECT: Kavitha Subramaniam

Kavitha Subramaniam, age 44. Finance Director of the company and Subramaniam Pillai's wife. Controlled all financial accounts and bank transactions. Rs. 1.4 crore transferred to accounts in her name from company funds. CCTV confirms her presence at the office on 27 October 2025, removing documents. Also absconding since 28 October. Warrant issued. As Finance Director she would have been fully aware of the Ponzi structure and the double accounting system. Email records show she was in direct communication with Prakash Iyer regarding fund transfer structuring. No prior criminal record but her role as Finance Director makes her a primary co-accused. Strong motive: direct financial benefit and joint orchestration of fraud.

SUSPECT: Ramesh Kumar

Ramesh Kumar, age 38. Kavitha Subramaniam's brother. Director of Greenfield Enterprises Pvt. Ltd. — the Bengaluru shell company that received Rs. 80 lakh from Lakshmi Chit Fund accounts. Greenfield Enterprises has no genuine business activity — no employees, no office, no GST filings. Claims the transfer was a legitimate business loan repayment. Cannot produce any loan agreement. Bank records show Rs. 80 lakh was withdrawn in cash from Greenfield's account within 5 days of receipt. Was present at the Anna Nagar office on 27 October — identified as the unrecognised individual seen by the peon helping carry boxes. No prior criminal record. Motive: money laundering for his sister and brother-in-law.

SUSPECT: Prakash Iyer

Prakash Iyer, age 51. Chartered accountant who prepared the company's official financial statements. Email records recovered from the company server show communications with Subramaniam Pillai discussing how to structure fund transfers to avoid detection and how to present the company's books to pass regulatory scrutiny. Claims the emails were taken out of context and he was providing legitimate tax planning advice. ICAI (Institute of Chartered Accountants) has been notified and a disciplinary inquiry is pending. Has prior complaints from two clients for professional misconduct. Motive: professional fees and possible commission from the fraud operation.

SUSPECT: Ramamurthy

Ramamurthy, age 48. Lead collection agent based in Tambaram. Recruited the largest number of investors — approximately 90 individuals — through personal networks and community contacts. Received 2% commission on Rs. 1.1 crore collected — totalling Rs. 2.2 lakh in commission payments. Claims he was deceived by the promoters and genuinely believed the scheme was legitimate. Produced his own investment of Rs. 2 lakh as evidence of good faith. Cooperating fully with the investigation and has provided detailed witness statements. His role appears to be that of an unknowing participant rather than a conspirator. No prior criminal record. Low direct criminal suspicion — potential victim and witness rather than accused.

SUSPECT: Nirmala Devi

Nirmala Devi, age 61. Nominee third director of the company. A retired schoolteacher who was approached by Subramaniam Pillai — a distant relative — and asked to sign documents as a director in exchange for Rs. 5,000 per month. Claims she did not understand the nature of the documents she signed and had no operational role. Never attended a board meeting or had access to company accounts. Her signature appears on the company incorporation documents but nowhere on any financial transaction records. No financial benefit beyond the Rs. 5,000 monthly payment. No prior criminal record. Considered a nominee director victim. Low criminal culpability though legally liable as a registered director.

SUSPECT: Harish Babu

Harish Babu, age 33. Web developer who built the company's professional-looking website. Was paid Rs. 35,000 for the work — a normal market rate. No evidence that he was aware the company was fraudulent. Has developed websites for several other legitimate businesses. Cooperating with investigation. Not implicated in any financial transactions. No prior criminal record. Alibi for office closure date: was in Madurai for a family function, confirmed by hotel records and family members. No motive, no benefit beyond professional fee. Very low suspicion.

SUSPECT: Saraswathi Pillai

Saraswathi Pillai, age 54. Wife of Subramaniam Pillai, the primary accused. Rs. 1.4 crore was transferred to accounts in her name from company funds. Claims she was unaware of the source of the funds and believed they were legitimate savings transferred by her husband. Enforcement Directorate is investigating her accounts under PMLA provisions. Is cooperating with authorities and has not absconded unlike her husband. No prior criminal record. Her culpability depends on whether she knowingly participated in concealing the funds. Investigation and asset attachment ongoing. Moderate suspicion as beneficiary of the fraud proceeds.